

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Want to hear my elevator pitch?



Learning Outcome

Discuss factual and abstract information about common everyday or job related topics in both work and social contexts appropriate for the interlocutor.

Ask your partner:

- What do you find easy or difficult about talking about your background?
- Do you like talking about your hopes and plans for the future? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can exchange opinions about events or actions related to work and jobs.
- I can talk about solving problems.
- I can express necessity, duty, and advice about a work-related process.

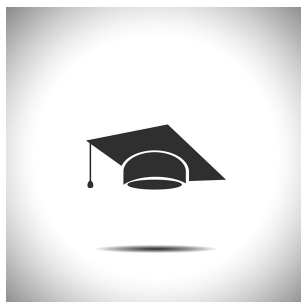




Let's Explore!

Adam meets with Mr. Goldstein, the headhunter. He recommends using **digital media***.

* "Digital media" means electronic forms of communication, like websites or social media.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Mr. Goldstein: You must be Adam! Welcome!

Adam: Thank you, Mr. Goldstein. I really appreciate you taking the time to meet with me today.

Mr. Goldstein: My pleasure, young man. You mustn't feel ashamed of asking for help. As soon as young people graduate, they need to start looking for a job. Often, they must continue looking for a very long time.

Adam: I'm getting a little discouraged. A few interviews have gone south lately.

Mr. Goldstein: I understand. You're looking for another chance.

Adam: Yes, I really want to work in communications.

Mr. Goldstein: Excellent. Ever since I read a book on digital media, I have been convinced that their careers in communications will be in demand in the future. Do you have an elevator pitch?

Adam: What's that?

Mr. Goldstein: An "elevator pitch" is a short, pre-prepared speech that explains what you want to do. The goal is to make someone interested in your ideas while you are going up 5 floors on an elevator.

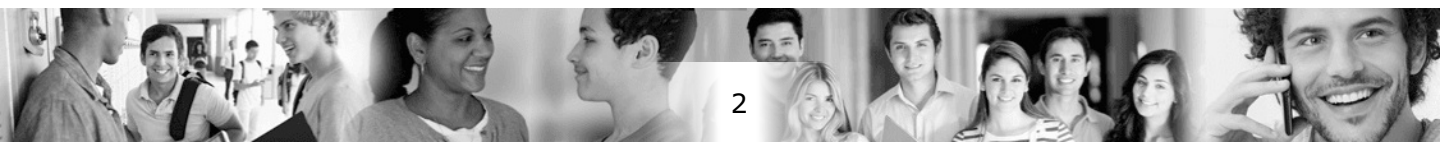
Adam: That's not much time.

Mr. Goldstein: No, it's not. Imagine you've just bumped into a former colleague at the airport. He asks you what you are presently doing. You want to talk about your plans, and maybe schedule a meeting. As you try to organize your thoughts, his flight is called, and he's on his way. Your ideas require organizing in advance.

Adam: That makes a lot of sense. I need to prepare for a situation like that.

Mr. Goldstein: Your pitch needs to be written with a clear objective in mind. It needn't be very long or complicated. You should also use and emphasize key words, like action verbs or adjectives. Then, your pitch needs to be practiced.

Adam: I guess I'll be going up and down a lot of elevators in near future!





Let's Practice!

Adam prepares his elevator speech.

Instructions: Circle all the modals of necessity in each sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. You mustn't feel ashamed of asking for help.
2. Often, they must continue looking for a very long time.
3. I need to prepare for a situation like that.
4. It needn't be very long or complicated.
5. I must practice my elevator speech.



Let's Practice!

Adam is getting his elevator speech ready.

Instructions: Complete the sentences by choosing and writing the hints you are given.

Word Bank

be practiced / needs to / organizing / practicing / changing

1. You should try _____ your speech with someone.
2. You need to consider _____ your approach to your job search.
3. Your ideas require _____ in advance.
4. Your pitch _____ be written with a clear objective in mind.
5. Then, your pitch needs to _____.





Extension Activity

Prepare a list of jobs and careers that will be in demand in the future.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online. Find out what jobs are expected to be in demand in the future. Find 10 different jobs.
- Visit at least 3 different websites to compare answers.
- Organize the jobs into different career fields (for example: healthcare, technology, agriculture, etc.)
- Share the results of your study with a partner.
- Talk about which jobs you would like to have and which jobs you would not like to have.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I read about jobs in demand in the future.

☐☐

I organize the jobs into career fields.

☐☐

I discuss future jobs with a partner.

☐☐

Target Words

- **to go south** (expression): to turn out badly
e.g. A few interviews have gone south lately.
- **elevator pitch** (noun): a short speech used to get an employer's attention
e.g. Do you have an elevator pitch?
- **discouraged** (adjective): frustrated due to lack of success
e.g. I'm getting a little discouraged.
- **speech** (noun): a message delivered orally
e.g. An "elevator pitch" is a short, pre-prepared speech that explains what you want to do.
- **complicated** (adjective): difficult; complex
e.g. It needn't be very long or complicated.
- **in demand** (expression): a lot of need for people in a certain area, or a particular product or something that is wanted or desired.
e.g. Ever since I read a book on digital media, I have been convinced that their careers in communications will be in demand in the future.



Learning Points

Solving Problems: Infinitives and Gerunds (Passive Forms)

Gerunds are **nouns** derived from **verbs**. A **gerund** is a **verb** with an -ing, e.g. *taking, asking, organizing*. They are used as any other **noun** is used. They sometimes can be used to describe general activities or abstract ideas.

For example:

Using digital media is a modern method to get a job.

Infinitives are the base or simple form of a **verb** and contain the word *to*. *Need* is usually used with an **infinitive** or an object + an **infinitive**.

For example:

I need to prepare for a situation like that.

After certain **verbs** (like *need* and *require*), the **gerund** takes on a passive meaning on its own. You do not need to use the passive voice.

For example:

This report needs rewriting = This report needs to be rewritten.

Your pitch requires practicing = Your pitch needs to be practiced.

Remember that whether you use a **gerund** or **infinitive** after certain **verbs** can affect the meaning of what you want to say.

Examples:

- *Your ideas require organizing in advance.*
- *Your pitch needs to be written with a clear objective in mind.*
- *Then, your pitch needs to be practiced.*

Expressing Necessity: **Need** and **Needn't**

You use the modal **need** to express necessity - when something has to be done. This is out of obligation or due to a set protocol at work or in a social setting.

When you want to talk about when something is not necessary, use the modal **needn't** (not **mustn't**, which refers to something that is prohibited, rather than not necessary).

For example:

*Your pitch **needn't** be very long or complicated.*

*You **needn't** spend a lot of time preparing a long speech.*

*You **mustn't** feel ashamed of asking for help.*

